

This comprehensive document, **The Design Pipeline: MVP Technical and Functional Specification (V1.0)**, is the finalized blueprint for your custom CRM solution. It consolidates all requirements—from the strategic architectural choices to the detailed 13-step workflow, data structure, and automation logic—providing your technical team with the necessary instructions to begin Phase I MVP development immediately.

The purpose of this custom-built system is to prove to investors that your unique interior design workflow requires a tailored, cost-effective tool, making complicated and expensive subscription CRMs (like Zoho, Pipedrive, or HubSpot) redundant for your specific needs [C, 5, 223].

THE DESIGN PIPELINE: MVP TECHNICAL AND FUNCTIONAL SPECIFICATION (V1.0)

I. Project Strategy and Architectural Foundation

A. Core Project Goal and Philosophy

The MVP is designed to replace complicated and expensive subscription CRMs [C, 5, 223]. The underlying philosophy is that a **simple system with only the necessary features is more effective** than bloated software, which reduces user adoption and increases costs [184, C].

The system must be built on the principle of **Domain-Driven Design (DDD)** to perfectly implement the specifics of your 13-step interior design project workflow [C, 166, 323].

B. Technical Stack and Hosting Strategy

To achieve rapid deployment, cost control, and customization (a **Piecemeal MVP** approach), we mandate a lightweight, LCNC architecture for Phase I.

Component	Recommended Tool(s)	Justification / Functionality
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Data Storage & Schema	Airtable or Notion	Provides a flexible, centralized DIY CRM setup allowing for easy creation of custom fields (e.g., for questionnaire data) [C, 203, 573].
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Interface & Pipeline	Airtable/Notion Kanban Views or Glide	Kanban boards are essential for tracking deals and providing a global view of pipelines [28, 15, C]. Glide is excellent for quickly making custom AI apps for mobile and web.
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Automation Engine	Make (formerly Integromat) or Zapier	A good simple CRM requires automation capabilities. These platforms are highly effective for connecting the database to communication channels to handle the critical Automated Payment Reminder System [8, 38, 39, 187, C].
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Mobile Access	Glide or Built-in LCNC Apps	Essential for ensuring on-the-go access for site visits and continuous engagement [10, 13, 517, C].
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Hosting Strategy	LCNC Provider Hosting	Hosting and infrastructure management are handled by the platform vendor, reducing technical overhead and avoiding high infrastructure costs (e.g., Kubernetes/Docker Swarm) [C, 157].
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II. Detailed Workflow Mapping: The 13-Step Pipeline

The CRM pipeline (Table 2) must be configured sequentially, mapping exactly to the project flow defined in **Version 1.pdf**.

Step #	CRM Stage Name	Required Data Input (Manual)	Required Action / Automation Trigger
1	Lead Generation	Capture Contact Info.	Auto-assign lead to Sales Manager [C].
2	Initial Engagement	Portfolio Sent confirmation.	Task: Send detailed questionnaire [536, C].
3	Scheduling Visit	Log Date/Time of Experience Centre Visit (Notion integration) [537, C].	Automation: Send reminder message to client [537, C].
4	Consultation & Data Capture	Log MoM notes.	Automation: Feed detailed questionnaire responses into custom CRM fields (Table 1) [537, C]. Task: Validate all custom fields are populated [C].
5	Design in Progress	Schedule Presentation date [537, C].	Task: Designer must meet presentation deadline [C].
6	Design Presentation & Fee Due	Upload Estimate Sheet and Presentation Guide [538, C].	Automation (Revenue Trigger 1): Trigger generation/sharing of Design Fee Invoice (₹35K–₹48K) [538, C].
7	Costing Shared	Upload Detailed Costing to CRM (Table 3) [538, C].	Task: Await Client Confirmation/Agreement [C].
8	Contract Signed (50% Due)	Contract signed confirmation.	Automation (Revenue Trigger 2): Trigger 50% Advance Invoice. Automation: Activate Automated Reminder System until payment is collected [539, C].
9	Site Measurement Visit	Upload Site Visit Checklist (Table 3) [539, C].	Task: Team visits the site for final measurements [C].
10	Detailed Drawings & Vendor Coordination	Share final drawings confirmation [540, C].	Status updates shared with Design Team [C].
11	Production (40% Interim Due)	Material orders placed confirmation [540, C].	Automation (Revenue Trigger 3): Trigger 40% Interim Invoice. Automation: Continue/Activate Automated Reminder System until payment is collected [540, C].
12	Project Closure (Final 10% Payment)	Present Handover Pack confirmation [541, C].	Automation (Revenue Trigger 4): Trigger Final Invoice. Automation: Continue/Activate Automated Reminder System until payment is collected [541, C].
13	Project Completed	Log Case Holder Assignment details.	Capture Testimonial [541, C]. Project moved to "Testimonial/Referral" list for future outreach [541, C].

III. Database Schema Specification (Logical Blueprint)

The database schema is the blueprint that outlines how data is organized, including tables, columns, data types, relationships, and constraints. The four tables must support **One-to-Many (1:M)** and **Many-to-One (M:1)** relationships.

Table 1: Clients (Contact Management & Custom Requirements)

This table handles custom data capture essential for design and costing phases.

Field Name	Data Type/Format	Purpose in Workflow
Client ID	Unique ID	Unique identifier for the client.
Associated Deals	Link to Deals Table	Relationship: One Client to Many Projects (1:M).
Style Preference(s)	Multi-Select	Informs the 3D Design (Step 5)
Functionality Goals	Long Text	Captures lifestyle needs; crucial input for the Design Team
Target Budget (Hard Limit)	Currency	Critical input for Detailed Costing (Step 7)
Key Material Preferences	Multi-Select	Guides costing and material selection
Questionnaire Upload Link	File Link/Attachment	Stores the full questionnaire document (Step 2)

Table 2: Deals/Projects (The 13-Step Pipeline Tracker)

This is the central entity that drives the Kanban board view.

Field Name	Data Type/Format	Purpose
Deal ID	Unique ID	Unique identifier for the project.
Current Stage	Single Select (1-13 stages)	Drives the Kanban board view
Total Project Value	Currency	Final detailed costing amount (from Step 7).
Associated Client	Link to Clients Table	Links project back to client's requirements (M:1)
Associated Payments	Link to Payments Table	Links to invoicing records (1:M).
Testimonial Captured	Checkbox/Boolean	Status of post-sale feedback (Step 13)

Table 4: Payments and Invoicing (Revenue Assurance Logic)

This table tracks financial milestones and triggers the automated reminder system

Field Name	Data Type/Format	Purpose
Payment ID	Unique ID	Unique identifier for the invoice/payment.
Invoice Stage	Single Select	(e.g., "Design Fee," "50% Advance," "Final 10%").
Due Date	Date	Deadline for the payment.
Payment Status	Single Select	(e.g., "Sent," "Overdue," "Collected")
Associated Project	Link to Deals Table	Links payment to the master deal record (M:1)
Reminder Automation	Formula/Logic	Logic trigger for automated follow-up

V. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) Specification

The system must implement RBAC to ensure that users only have access to the data and features relevant to their jobs [232, 144, 323, C]. This design is essential to simplifying the user experience and ensuring high adoption [C].

CRM Role	Workflow Focus (Steps)	Key Access / Permissions

Founder / Executive	Strategy & Oversight (All)	**Read/View All** tables and Dashboards. Limited Edit rights [C].
Lead & Sales Manager	Acquisition & Qualification (1–4)	**Create/Edit** Client Records (Table 1) and Deal Cards (Table 2). Edit pipeline status up to Step 7 [C].
Design Team	Creative & Costing (5–7, 10)	**View** Client Questionnaire Responses (Table 1). **Upload/Edit** Documents (Table 3). Edit pipeline status in relevant design stages [C].
Finance & Payments	Revenue Collection (6, 8, 11, 12)	**Create/Edit** Payment/Invoice records (Table 4). Manages the **Automated Reminder System** settings [C].
Project Manager / Site Ops	Execution & Closure (9–13)	**Upload/Edit** Documents (Site Checklist). **Edit** execution-related pipeline status (Steps 9–13) [C].

VI. Automation Logic: Revenue Assurance System

The **Automated Payment Reminder System** must be configured via the Automation Engine (Make/Zapier) to execute the following logic:

A. Trigger Events

WHEN the 'Current Stage' in **Table 2** is updated to a payment milestone (Steps 6, 8, 11, or 12), **THEN** a new payment record is created in **Table 4** with 'Payment Status' set to 'Sent' and a 'Due Date' [C].

B. Automated Reminder Sequence

The system runs a continuous check for overdue conditions:

* **Logic:** **IF** ('Payment Status' is NOT 'Collected') **AND** ('Due Date' < Today) [C].
* **Action:** Execute timed follow-up messages (email/SMS/WhatsApp) [C].
* **Escalation:** If payment is overdue (e.g., Day 7), a high-priority task/alert must be assigned to the **Founder / Executive** role [C].

VII. Design and User Experience (UI/UX) Requirements

The design must prioritize **simplicity, speed, and intuitiveness** to overcome previous user frustration, ensuring the tool is not overly complicated.

- Tailored Simplicity (Low Friction):** The interface must be low-friction, utilizing clear icons and a minimal feature set, showing **only essential information** [C, 28, 184].
- Workflow Visualization:** Use **intuitive Kanban boards** prominently. Users **must be able to update deal status directly on the Kanban board** (drag-and-drop or single click) without navigating to a separate "main table board" [196, C, 28].
- Mobile-First Design:** The system must be fully **mobile-responsive** for on-the-go access (site visits) and designed for easy navigation on small screens, prioritizing **simple one-click filters** [480, 512, 517, C].
- Action-Centric Dashboard Design (ACDD):** The main screen must be a **minimalist dashboard**, showing a maximum of 10 visualizations [510, C]. It must organize data logically, moving from broad

strategic metrics to specific operational drivers [510, C].

B. Executive Reporting Requirements

The Founder/Executive dashboard must clearly display ROI metrics, adhering to the ACDD principle of tailoring the dashboard to the leader's strategic decisions.

Metric (KPI)	Visualization Type	Insight for Executive
Total Pipeline Value	Large KPI Card/Trend Line	Strategic assessment of potential revenue [C].
Overdue Payments Count	Prominent Red KPI Card	Actionable Insight Highest priority risk indicator, proving the automation system's value [C].
Stage Distribution	Visual Kanban Board	Provides real-time status and volume across the 13 steps [C].
Funnel Drop-off Rate	Funnel Chart	Identifies process friction and bottlenecks (e.g., between Step 7 and 8) [C].
Testimonial Capture Rate	KPI Card (Percentage)	Measures success of post-sale follow-up (Step 13) [C].

The technical development plan is comprehensive and complete, covering the entire lifecycle from data input to automated revenue tracking and executive reporting.

The next logical step is to ensure that the development team is ready to deploy this system effectively, meaning the end-users must be prepared to adopt the simpler interface immediately.

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